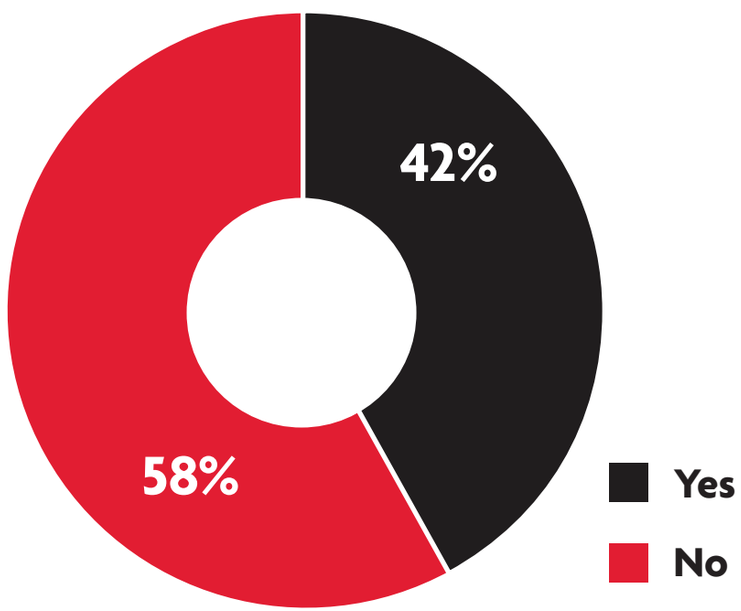
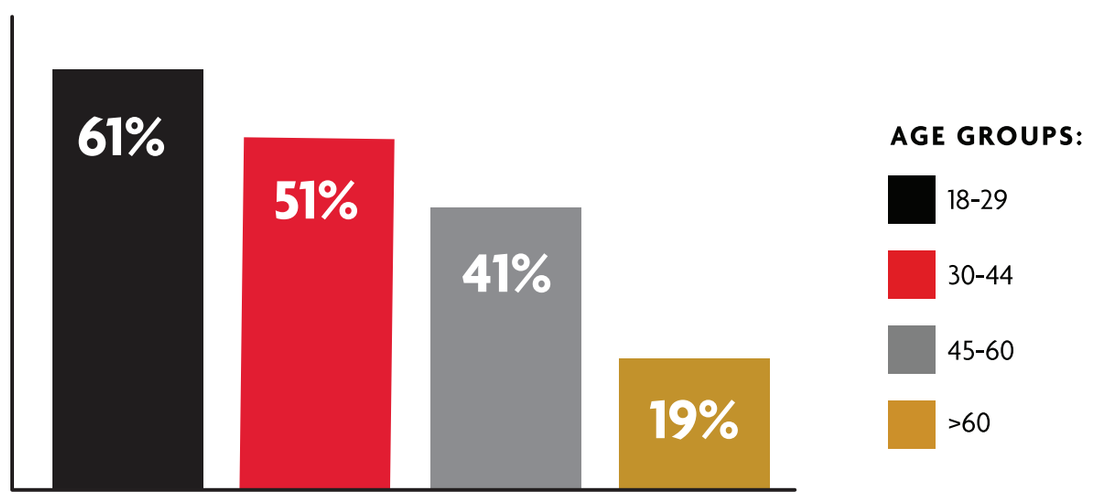
The younger the shopper, the more influenced they were by sustainable business practices.

"While shopping during the 2024 holiday season, did any stores'/brands' sustainable business practices influence your purchase decisions (e.g., products made from eco-friendly materials, use of recycled packaging, fuel-efficient transportation methods, etc.)?"





Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

HOLIDAY PREP REPORT:
OMNICHANNEL



OMNICHANNEL:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

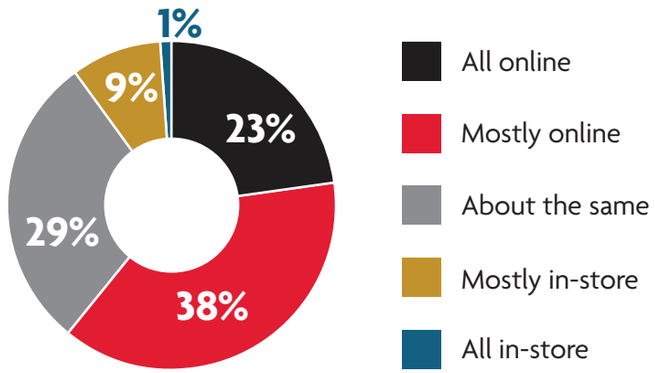
- 2024 holiday shopping increasingly occurred online, but consumers have no plans to abandon physical stores in 2025.
- In-store experience was the main driver of brick-and-mortar shopping.
- In-store pickup availability satisfied time-sensitive purchase needs during the 2024 holiday season.



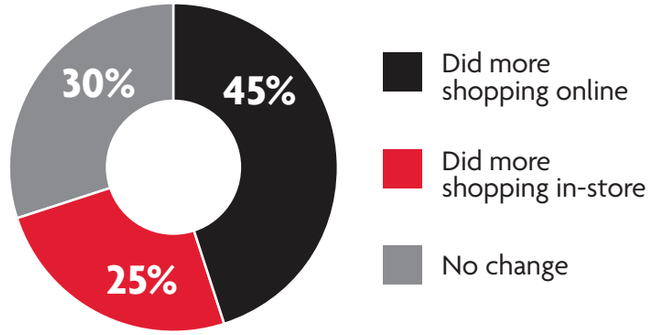
2024 holiday shopping increasingly occurred online, but consumers have no plans to abandon physical stores in 2025.

2024

Where consumers did their 2024 holiday shopping:

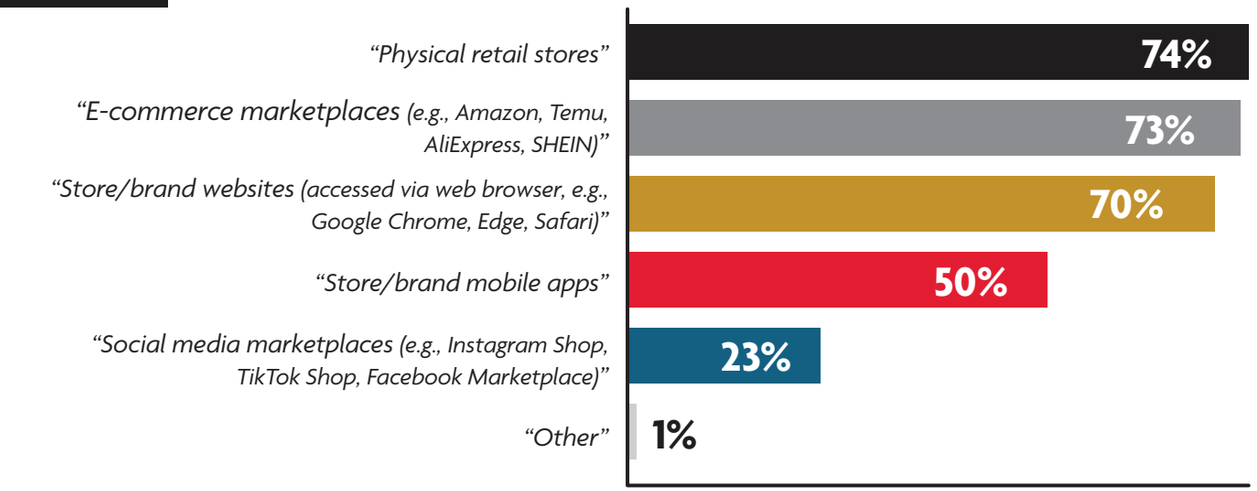


How 2024 holiday shopping behavior compared to 2023:



2025

Where consumers plan to shop during the 2025 holiday season:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

In-store experience was the main driver of brick-and-mortar shopping.

Most popular reasons for shopping in-store during the 2024 holiday season:



22%
shopped in-store **only** when they needed something immediately.



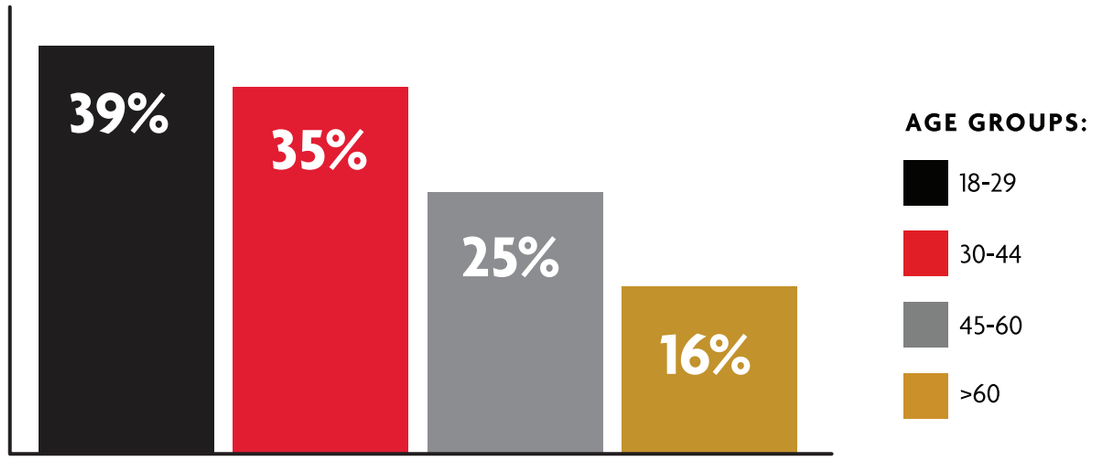
Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

In-store pickup availability satisfied time-sensitive purchase needs during the 2024 holiday season.



29% of shoppers purchased something during the 2024 holiday season that was available via in-store pickup specifically because it was faster than standard delivery.

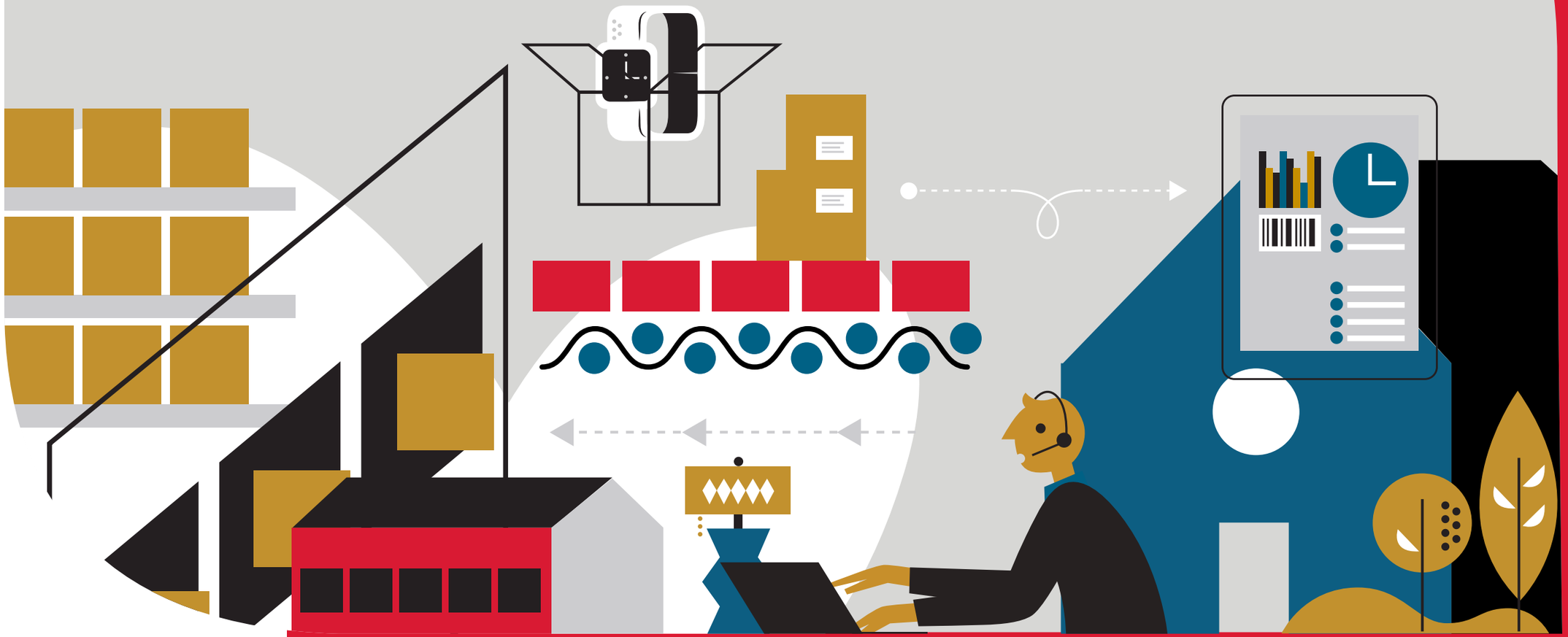
This was prevalent among younger shoppers:



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

HOLIDAY PREP REPORT:

SHIPPING & RETURNS



SHIPPING & RETURNS:
KEY TAKEAWAYS

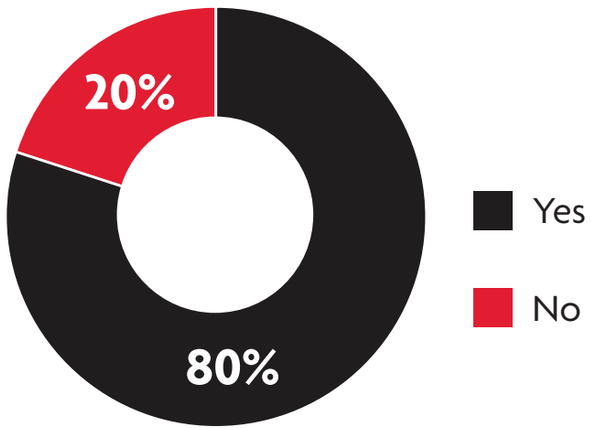
- Free shipping heavily motivated 2024 holiday purchases and is likely to continue doing so in 2025.
- Poor delivery management during the 2024 holiday season resulted in lost business.
- Return fees discourage holiday purchases.



Free shipping heavily motivated 2024 holiday purchases and is likely to continue doing so in 2025.

2024

"While shopping during the 2024 holiday season, did the availability of free shipping encourage you to make any of your purchases?"



2025

76%

of respondents report that free shipping is more likely than any other factor to influence their 2025 holiday purchasing decisions.



Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Poor delivery management during the 2024 holiday season resulted in lost business.

17%

of shoppers returned at least one order because it arrived too late.

10%

will no longer shop with a specific company following a negative delivery experience.

13%

canceled at least one order due to slow shipping.

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

Return fees discourage holiday purchases.

2024

37%

of respondents reported that the absence of a free-return policy prevented them from making a 2024 holiday shopping purchase.



2025

"Which of the following factors are most likely to influence your 2025 holiday purchasing decisions?"

#1	Free shipping	#7	Extended return window
#2	Sales/Discounts	#8	Scheduled delivery
#3	**Free returns**	#9	Products are made in the U.S.A.
#4	Fast shipping (2 days or less)	#10	Buy Now Pay Later options
#5	Price matching	#11	Eco-friendly or sustainable product options
#6	Loyalty rewards		

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding and/or because respondents could select more than one answer.

METHODOLOGY
Special Report: 2025 Holiday Prep

In January 2025, Ryder contracted a third-party research company to survey 503 online shoppers* about their behavior, preferences, experiences, and expectations during the 2024 holiday shopping season. Subject matter comprised purchasing behavior, shipping, returns, omnichannel experience, and sustainability.

Gender breakdown:	Male: **49%**	Female: **52%**
Age breakdown:	18-29: **13%**	46-60: **33%**
	30-44: **34%**	>60: **20%**
Regional breakdown:	South: **37%**	Midwest: **22%**
	West: **23%**	Northeast: **18%**

In May 2025, Ryder followed up with a pulse survey of 525 online shoppers* about their plans and expectations leading up to the 2025 holiday shopping season. Subject matter comprised plans surrounding purchasing, shipping, returns, and omnichannel preferences and behavior.

Gender breakdown:	Male: **49%**	Female: **51%**
Age breakdown:	18-29: **14%**	46-60: **33%**
	30-44: **31%**	>60: **23%**
Regional breakdown:	South: **36%**	Midwest: **22%**
	West: **22%**	Northeast: **20%**

Note: Percentages may not total 100% due to rounding.

**All respondents reported shopping online either "often," "sometimes," or "all the time."*

ABOUT RYDER SYSTEM, INC.

Ryder System, Inc. (NYSE: R) is a fully integrated port-to-door logistics and transportation company. It provides supply chain, dedicated transportation, and fleet management solutions, including warehousing and distribution, contract packaging and manufacturing, e-commerce fulfillment, last-mile delivery, managed transportation, professional drivers, freight brokerage, cross-border solutions, full-service fleet leasing, maintenance, commercial truck rental, and used vehicle sales to some of the world's most-recognized brands. Ryder provides services to businesses across more than 20 industries throughout the United States, Mexico, and Canada. In addition, Ryder manages nearly 250,000 commercial vehicles, services fleets at approximately 760 maintenance locations, and operates nearly 300 warehouses encompassing more than 100 million square feet. Ryder is regularly recognized for its industry-leading practices; technology-driven innovations; environmental management; safety, health and security programs; and recruitment and hiring initiatives.

www.ryder.com

